Armour made with seven or eight overlapping plates

Plates with intricate designs in inlay or relief

**Cuirass**
Body armour made of overlapping iron plates was common, but by no means universal in the 1st century CE. It is the kind worn by the legionaries depicted on Trajan's Column in Rome. It may have weighed as much as 9kg (20lb) and for the armour to sit comfortably there was probably some kind of padded lining worn underneath.



Fastening the cuirass



Leather purse attached to belt

**Belt and apron**
When a legionary was not wearing his armour, it was his ornate belt *(balteus)* and apron of studded straps which hung from it that marked him out as a soldier. And when a legionary was given a dishonourable discharge, he was formally stripped of his belt.

**Tunic**
Soldiers' woollen tunics were shorter than those worn by civilians, but were otherwise essentially the same. They were probably off-white or dyed red. The colour may have had some significance in terms of rank.

Openwork upper, all cut from a single piece of leather

Pattern of nails supporting heel and ball of foot



**Army sandals**
Soldiers' hard-wearing, iron-nailed sandals were known as *caligae* (boots). In the 1st century CE, they were made to more or less the same pattern right across the empire.



